

Dr. Alejandro Bernales

Ph.D. in Finance

School of Economics and Business

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English: Fluent Spanish: Native French: Intermediate

Summary

Alejandro Bernales is a consultant, advisor, researcher, and academic with over 20 years of international experience in financial economics. He is an Associate Professor (with tenure) at the School of Economics and Business at Universidad de Chile, where he also serves as Director of Research and Director of the Master's in Finance program.

Dr. Bernales has held positions as a Research Fellow at the Inter-American Development Bank, a Marie Curie Fellow at the European Commission, and an economist at both the Banque de France (the Central Bank of France) and the Central Bank of Chile. He has served on the Scientific Committee for Economics and Business at Chile's National Agency for Research and Development (ANID), within the Ministry of Science. Additionally, he has been a visiting professor at various international institutions, including the University of Sydney, Goethe University Frankfurt, and ESSEC Business School.

He has extensive experience as a director in the financial sector and has provided consultancy services to a wide range of institutions, such as companies, law firms, international organizations, and governments. His expertise encompasses regulation, impact evaluation, legal cases involving the financial sector, corporate events, investments, valuations, and portfolio strategies.

Dr. Bernales has published numerous scientific articles in international journals specializing in financial economics and finance. He regularly contributes opinion columns to newspapers and online media. He is fluent in Spanish and English, with an intermediate proficiency level in French.

Dr. Bernales earned his Ph.D. in Finance from the University of Manchester, United Kingdom, and holds a Master's degree in Financial Engineering and a Bachelor's degree in Industrial Engineering from the Catholic University of Chile.

Positions

2020–Present **Associate Professor (with Tenure)**, *School of Economics and Business, Universidad de Chile, Santiago, Chile*

2014–2020 **Assistant Professor**, *Universidad de Chile, Santiago, Chile*

2017 **Visiting Professor**, *University of Sydney, Sydney, Australia*

2016 **Visiting Professor**, *Goethe University Frankfurt, Frankfurt, Germany*

2015 **Visiting Professor**, *Instituto Universitário de Lisboa, Lisbon, Portugal*

- 2014–2015 **Research Fellow**, *International Finance and Banking Society (IFABS)*, UK
- 2011–2014 **Research Economist**, *Banque de France*, Paris, France
- 2013–2014 **Adjunct Professor of Finance**, *Universidad de Chile*, Santiago, Chile
- 2012–2013 **Adjunct Professor of Finance**, *ESSEC Business School*, Paris, France
- 2011–2012 **Adjunct Professor of Finance**, *Université Catholique de Lille*, Lille, France
- 2007–2011 **Marie Curie Fellow**, *European Commission*, Belgium
- 2007 **Researcher**, *Central Bank of Chile*, Santiago, Chile
- 2005–2007 **Research Fellow**, *Inter-American Development Bank (IDB)*, Washington DC, USA
- 2004–2005 **Researcher**, *Lab. for Financial Research*, *Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile*, Santiago, Chile

Consultancy

- 2005–Present **Consultant**, *as a consultant, I work with a variety of institutions, including private sector companies, international organizations, and governments. My expertise spans areas such as regulation, legal cases involving the financial sector, corporate events, investment decisions, valuation, and portfolio strategies*
- 2017–2019 **Board Member**, *CUANTSERV - Stratagemma Trading Systems*
- 2017–2018 **Research Advisor**, *CUANTSERV - Stratagemma Trading Systems*

Academic Service

- 2024–Present **Director of Research**, *School of Economics and Business, Universidad de Chile*
- 2023–Present **Tenure-track Committee for Young Faculty**, *School of Economics and Business, Universidad de Chile*
- 2022–Present **Recruitment Committee**, *School of Economics and Business, Universidad de Chile*
- 2020–2026 **Director of the Master in Finance**, *School of Economics and Business, Universidad de Chile*
- 2022–2025 **Central Electoral Commission**, *Government office at the Universidad de Chile*
- 2023 **Scientific Committee (Economics and Business Research Area)**, *National Agency of Research and Development, Ministry of Science, Government of Chile*
- 2019–2020 **Advisory Board Member**, *Undergraduate Program, Universidad de Chile*
- 2018–2020 **Advisory Board Member**, *Ph.D. Program, Universidad de Chile*

Research Areas

My research focuses on financial economics and finance, including both empirical and theoretical studies, as well as other fields involving financial or investment decisions.

Publications and working papers (with revise-and-resubmit and reject-and-resubmit) in WoS journals

1. Decomposing Informed Trading in Equity Options, 2026 (with F. Asencio, D. González, R. Holowczak, and T. Verousis), **Journal of Econometrics**.
2. Aggregate Risk and Lending Decisions in the Interbank Market, 2026 (with A. Bechara, C. Cañon and N. Garrido), **Journal of Money, Credit and Banking**.
3. Informational Economic Transmission between Countries, 2025 (with H. Karnani, P. Margaretic), **Review of Economic Dynamics**.
4. Execution Risk and Price Improvement under Dark Pools, 2025 (with D. Ladley, E. Litos and M. Valenzuela), **Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control**.
5. International Spillover Effects of Economic Policy Uncertainty, 2025 (with D. Cumming, P. Margaretic and R. Muñoz), Revise and Resubmit at **Journal of International Business Studies**.
6. The Nonlinear Dynamics of Relative Collateralized-Uncollateralized Funding Activity, 2025 (with A. Bechara, C. Cañon and N. Garrido), Revise and Resubmit at **Journal of Empirical Finance**.
7. Trader Competition in Fragmented Markets: Liquidity Supply versus Picking-off Risk, 2024 (with N. Garrido, S. Sagade, M. Valenzuela, and C. Westheide), **Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis** (forthcoming).
 ○ *Best Paper Award 2017 Asian Finance Association*
8. Speculative Bubbles under Supply Constraints, Background Risk and Investment Fraud in the Art Market, 2022 (with L. Reus and V. Valdenegro), **Journal of Corporate Finance** 77, Article 101746.
9. The Effect of Environmental Policies on Risk Reductions in Energy Generation, 2021 (with A. Flores, R. Moreno and A. Inzunza), **Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control** 126, Article 104027.
10. Learning and Index Option Returns, 2020 (with G. Cortazar and G. Skiadopoulos), **Journal of Business and Economic Statistics** 38:2, 327–339.
11. Blue-Collar Crime and Finance, 2022 (with D. W. Beuermann, D. Cumming and C. Olid), **Journal of International Financial Markets, Institutions and Money** (forthcoming).
12. Do Investors Follow the Herd in Option Markets?, 2020 (with T. Verousis and N. Voukelatos), **Journal of Banking and Finance** 119, Article 104899.
 ○ *Nominated for Best Conference Paper at the FMA (2015)*.
13. What Do We Know About Individual Equity Options?, 2020 (with T. Verousis, N. Voukelatos, and M. Zhang), **Journal of Futures Markets** 40: 67–91.
14. Make-Take Decisions under High-Frequency Trading Competition, 2019, **Journal of Financial Markets** 45, 1–18.
 ○ *Lead article in Journal of Financial Markets 2019*.
 ○ *Nominated for Best Conference Paper at the EFMA (2013)*.
15. Bid–Ask Spread and Liquidity Searching Behaviour of Informed Investors in Option Markets, 2018 (with T. Verousis and C. Cañon), **Finance Research Letters** 25, 96–106.
16. Learning and Forecasts about Option Returns through the Volatility Risk Premium, 2017 (with L. Chen and M. Valenzuela), **Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control** 82, 312–330.
 ○ *Nominated for Best Conference Paper at the EFMA (2014)*.
17. The Success of Option Listings, 2017, **Journal of Empirical Finance** 40, 139–167.

18. CVaR-Constrained Planning of Renewable Generation with Consideration of System Inertial Response, Reserve Services and Demand Participation, 2016, **Energy Economics** 59, 104–117.
19. Learning to Smile: Can Rational Learning Explain the Predictable Dynamics in the Implied Volatility Surface?, 2015 (with M. Guidolin), **Journal of Financial Markets** 26, 1–37.
 - *Nominated for Best Conference Paper at the FMA (2012).*
20. Thinly Traded Securities and Risk Management, 2014 (with G. Cortazar and D. Beuermann), **Estudios de Economía** 41, 5–48.
21. Can We Forecast the Implied Volatility Surface Dynamics for CBOE Equity Options?, 2014 (with M. Guidolin), **Journal of Banking and Finance** 46, 326–342.

Working Papers

1. A Nearby Wake-Up Call for Price Reaction Dynamics, 2026, (with N. Berardi and L. Reus), submitted.
2. Learning from news, information flow, and financial markets, 2025 (with M. Valenzuela and I. Zer), close to be submitted.
 - *Best Paper Award - Financial Engineering and Banking Society 2024.*
 - *Nominated for Best Conference Paper at the EFMA 2025.*
3. Effects of Information Overload on Financial Market Returns: How Much Is Too Much, 2025 (with M. Valenzuela and I. Zer), submitted.
4. Option Listings, Stock Price Informativeness and Investment Decisions, 2025 (with L. Chen, L. Reus, T. Verousis and J. Azocar), submitted.
5. Option Implied Correlation and Market Returns (with M. Valenzuela), 2024, close to be submitted.

Work in Progress

1. Understanding Collateral Chains (with Paula Margaretic and Carlos Canon).
2. Diffusion of the Option Adoption (with Thanos Verousis and David Diaz).
3. Dynamics in multi-markets: Quality and financial technological changes (with M. Valenzuela and O. Lebedeva).

Book Chapter

- The Effects of Derivatives on Underlying Financial Markets: Book: 50 Years of Money and Finance - Lessons and Challenges. Edited by Morten Balling and Ernest Gnan. Published by Larcier and SUERF Studies.

Policy Reports

- Algorithmic and High Frequency Trading: a Brief Synthesis, 2014, Research Department – Banque de France.
- Changes in the Correlation and Effects of Segmentation in the European Banking Sector, 2013, Research Department – Banque de France.
- Measurement of Systemic Risk, 2012, Research Department – Banque de France.
- Lessons from the Swedish Crisis in the Early 90s for the 2012 Spanish Storm in the Banking Sector, 2012, Research Department – Banque de France.
- The Measurement of Systemic Risk, 2012, Research Department – Banque de France.

- European Bonds Proposals: a Comparison, 2012, Research Department – Banque de France.
- Analysis of Alternative Efficient Indexation in Relation to Cap-Weighted Indices, 2011, Research Department – Banque de France.
- Performance Evaluation of the Implementation of Term-Structure Interest Rate Models Using Bonds Issued by the Central Bank of Chile, 2009, Central Bank of Chile.
- Country Program Evaluation Uruguay, 2005, Inter-American Development Bank (IDB).
- Annual Performance Evaluation of Development Projects in Region 2 (Central America, Mexico, Caribbean), 2005, Inter-American Development Bank (IDB).
- Annual Performance Evaluation of Development Projects in Region 2 (Central America, Mexico, Caribbean), 2006, Inter-American Development Bank (IDB).
- Country Program Evaluation Costa Rica, 2006, Inter-American Development Bank (IDB).
- Country Strategy Costa Rica, 2006, Inter-American Development Bank (IDB).

Grants, Honours and Scholarships

- 2026 Best Publication of the Year, School of Economics and Business Award (awarded study: “Decomposing Informed Trading in Equity Options,” 2026, *Journal of Econometrics*).
- 2025 Fondecyt Regular, Chilean Government research grant #1251636 (CoResearcher: US\$ 155,000 aprox., 4 years).
- 2024 Fondecyt Regular, Chilean Government research grant #1240312 (Co-Researcher: US\$ 150,000 aprox., 4 years).
- 2024 Best Paper Award / Financial Engineering and Banking Society.
- 2023 Fondecyt Regular, Chilean Government research grant #1231660 (Research Leader: US\$ 165,000 aprox., 4 years).
- 2023 Fondecyt Regular, Chilean Government research grant #1231630 (Co-Researcher: US\$ 160,000 aprox., 4 years).
- 2023 Research grant, FEN University of Chile grant #R156 (Research Leader: US\$ 8,000 aprox., 1 year).
- 2019 Fondecyt Regular, Chilean Government research grant #1190162 (Research Leader: US\$ 140,000 aprox., 4 years).
- 2019 Fondecyt Regular, Chilean Government research grant #1190477 (Co-Researcher: US\$ 143,000 aprox., 4 years).
- 2018 ENLACE grant #ENL13/18 (Research Leader: US\$ 12,000 aprox., 1 year).
- 2017 Best Paper Award / Asian Finance Association.
- 2015 Millennium Initiative grant – Institute for Research (US\$ 2,500,000 aprox., 5 years).
- 2014 Fondecyt Inic., Chilean Government research grant #11140628 (Research Leader: US\$ 135,000 aprox., 3 years).
- 2014 IFABS 2014 Fellowship grant.
- 2014 Visiting Scholars grant 2014 at Banque de France.
- 2011 Marie Curie Fellowship grant (4 years) – European Commission.

- 2010 Invitation from the International Institute of Forecasting – 30th Symposium on Forecasting (San Diego, USA) (Travel grant).
- 2009 Invitation from the American Finance Association (AFA) to attend the Annual Meeting (San Francisco, USA) (Travel grant).
- 2008 Young researcher invitation to attend The Nobel Laureate Meeting (Lindau, Germany) (Travel grant).
- 2007 Manchester Business School Doctoral Studentship (University of Manchester).
- 2004 Pontifical Catholic University of Chile Residence Scholarship.
- 2003 Pontifical Catholic University of Chile Parallel Degree Scholarship.
- 1997 Runner-up in the Chilean National Knowledge Olympics (in the field of Physics).

Conferences and Seminars

- 2025 European Financial Management Association Conference 2025 (Greece); University of Chile (Business School).
- 2024 The Society for Financial Econometrics - SoFiE Conference 2024 (Brazil); Financial Engineering and Banking Society Conference 2024 (Paris).
- 2023 News and Finance Conferences (Columbia University), Future of Financial Information (HEC-Paris), University of Chile (Econ. Dept.), IFABS Conference (University of Oxford), Banque de France.
- 2022 International Conference on Macroeconomic Analysis and International Finance.
- 2020 Annual Meeting of the Central Bank Research Association (CEBRA).
- 2019 PUC Rio; University of Birmingham; Bank of Mexico; FGV; University of los Andes; Banque de France; 4th International Workshop in Financial Econometrics (Brazil).
- 2018 Society for Financial Studies (SFS) Finance Cavalcade; Financial Management Association Conference.
- 2017 FIRS Conference; New York University; ITAM; PUC Chile; Banco de México; Third International Workshop in Financial Econometrics.
- 2016 Bocconi University; Goethe University Frankfurt; University of Piraeus.
- 2015 Federal Reserve Board; University of Colorado; Bank of England; University of York; University of Leicester; Central Bank of Brazil.
- 2014 New York University; City University of Hong Kong; Université Paris Dauphine; Universidade Católica Portuguesa; University of Bath; IFABS Conference; Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez; Banque de France.
- 2013 Toulouse School of Economics; Collège de France; CFTC; Schulich School of Business; IHS (Vienna); 9th ECB Workshop on Microstructure; EEA (Gothenburg); 3rd CFS/Deutsche Börse IOSDM; FMA (Chicago); UCL Algo and HFT; 30th FFA; 5th NYSE-Euronext Hedge-Fund Conference; Pontificia Universidad Javeriana; Rouen Business School; Universidad de Chile; Banque de France.

- 2012 Financial Management Association (FMA Atlanta); French Economic Association; Central Bank of Chile; IFABS Conference (Valencia); FEBS Conference (London).
- 2011 Federal Reserve Board (Research Department); University of Rotterdam; Banque de France; University of Leicester; Monash University; University of Melbourne; University of Manchester; IESEG; University of Liverpool; University of Lancaster.
- 2010 30th International Symposium on Forecasting (San Diego); EFMA (Aarhus); 8th INFINITI (Dublin); Safety and Risk in Complex Systems Symposium (Saint Petersburg, Russia).
- 2009 American Finance Association (AFA, San Francisco, USA).
- 2008 European Financial Management Association (EFMA, Athens); International Federation of Operational Research Societies Conference (South Africa).
- 2007 Financial Management Association (FMA, Orlando, USA); Midwest Finance Association (Chicago, USA); Global Finance Conference (Rio de Janeiro); Washington Area Finance Association (Washington DC, USA).

Teaching

- 2025 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).
- 2024 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).
- 2023 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate), Advanced Asset Pricing (Postgraduate).
- 2022 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).
- 2021 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate), Advanced Asset Pricing (Postgraduate).
- 2020 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).
- 2019 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate), Advanced Asset Pricing (Postgraduate).
- 2018 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).
- 2017 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).
- 2016 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).
- 2015 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).
- 2014 Asset Pricing (Undergraduate), Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).
- 2013 International Finance (Postgraduate).
- 2012 International Finance (Postgraduate), Fundamentals of Futures Markets (Postgraduate).
- 2011 Option Pricing and Strategies (Postgraduate).

Postgraduate Students

- Prieto Álvarez, Joaquín, 2023, Conexión informacional entre mercados financieros internacionales.

- Zúñiga Olave, Diego, 2023, Informational links in financial markets (Definición y estimación del canal informacional en el mercado accionario).
- Muñoz Álvarez, Rodrigo, 2022, Efectos directos y spillovers de incertidumbre política económica sobre inversión en activos fijos.
- Acevedo Echeverría, Giancarlo Andrés, 2022, Planificación óptima, un estudio sobre flexibilidad.
- Uribe Pizarro, Pablo Nicolás, 2022, Price changes and competition between french retailers.
- Peters Mosler, Javier Andrés, 2021, Do Peer AFP affect asset allocation decision.
- Valenzuela Herbosa, Miguel Ignacio, 2021, Market frictions in investment decisions due to peer effects.
- González Maldonado, Daniel Iván, 2021, Riesgo de información asimétrica en el mercado de opciones.
- Welch Soto, Javier Ignacio, 2020, Introducción de opciones estudio de sus retornos y del efecto en la sensibilidad inversión-Q.
- Azócar Romero, Javiera Alejandra, 2020, Variables que influyen en el proceso de adopción de nuevas opciones.
- Asencio Barría, Felipe Esteban, 2020, Market friction under asymmetric information in the option market
- Valdenegro Cabrera, Víctor Eduardo, 2018, Speculation and hedging in art markets
- Diego Bórquez O., Postgraduate, 2019, Volatilidad Accionaria y Spreads de Bonos Corporativos bajo Distintos Niveles de Endeudamiento y Caja.
- Christian Olid R., Tesis de Magíster, 2019, Blue-Collar Crime and Finance.
- Sebastián Matus F., Postgraduate, 2019, Creando un nuevo índice bilateral de integración política: Efectos en los flujos de capitales.
- Pedro Concha V., Postgraduate, 2018, Arbitraje en mercados financieros fragmentados.
- Nicolás Garrido S., Postgraduate, 2017, Dynamic equilibrium in multiple limit order markets: Overlapping.
- Sebastián Astargo Q., Postgraduate, 2017, Estudio del Proceso de Adopción de Nuevas Opciones Financieras y sus Retornos.
- Francisco Oteiza A., Postgraduate, 2017, Integración y condiciones económicas globales: Efectos en el crecimiento.
- Maricel Vargas V., Postgraduate, 2017, News in Dynamic Markets.
- Diego Sepúlveda S., Postgraduate, 2017, Rollover Risk, Cash Holdings and Credit Spreads: An Empirical Research.
- Rodrigo Orellana A., Postgraduate, 2016, Dynamic Equilibrium in Multiple Limit Order Markets: Analysis of Depth Disclosure and Lit Fragmentation.
- Fernando Brito G., Postgraduate, 2016, Fertility and Household Savings: The case of Chile.
- Nora Rugiero D., Postgraduate, 2015, Efectos del subsidio a la forestación: Evidencia al cambio en el Decreto Ley N° 701.

--- Other Academic Responsibilities

Refereeing:	Journal of Finance, Journal of Econometrics, Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control, Review of Finance, European Journal of Operational Research, Journal of Corporate Finance, Energy Economics, Journal of Empirical Finance, Finance Research Letters, Journal of Banking and Finance, Quantitative Finance, International Journal of Forecasting, among others.
Editorial Duties:	Guest editor at Journal of Corporate Finance (Special Issue on Corporate Finance Decisions in a Changing Global Environment).
Membership of Prof. Bodies:	American Finance Association; American Economic Association; European Economic Association; European Finance Association; Financial Management Association.
Conference Organizer:	Santiago Finance Workshop (2015–2025); IFABS-LA 2018; Chile-Brazil Finance Conference 2020; multiple others.

Computing Skills and Financial Database Knowledge

Computing Skills	Python, Java, Visual Basic, C, C++, Fortran, Matlab, Gauss, SAS, R, SQL Server, EViews, SPSS, Amos, Maple, AMPL, LaTeX.
Databases	TAQ, Bloomberg, OptionMetrics, Compustat, CRSP, I/B/E/S, among other financial databases.

Extra – Curricular Activities

2010–2014	Member of the Board of the Association of Chilean Students and Alumni UK/Ireland (£5,000 raised through different activities in UK and Ireland).
2005–2010	Member of the Chilean American Foundation (CAF) – supports small social-impact projects in Chile.
1998–2004	Voluntary unpaid social work in low-income communities in southern Chile.

Graduate Studies

2007–2011	PhD Finance – Manchester Business School, University of Manchester, UK. Thesis Title – Essays on Option Markets: Empirical and Theoretical Learning Models.
2003–2005	Master of Sciences (Financial Engineering) – Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile, Chile.

Undergraduate Studies

1998–2003	Industrial Engineering – Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile, Chile.
1998–2003	Major in Mechanical Engineering (parallel degree – completed 2005) – Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile, Chile.

References

References available upon request.